

Motivation at Work

Key-Terms Flashcards · GCSE & A-Level Business · print-and-fold A4

24 print-and-fold flashcards covering everything students need on motivation: the four big theories (Taylor, Mayo, Maslow, Herzberg), financial methods (piece rate, commission, bonus, profit sharing, fringe benefits, PRP) and non-financial methods (job enrichment, rotation, empowerment, delegation, autonomy, teamworking) – plus how motivation is measured (labour turnover, absenteeism).

How to use them

1. Print the three card sheets single-sided (grayscale is fine on any photocopier).
2. Cut along the outside of each card – eight to a page.
3. Fold each card on the dashed line: the **term/question is on the front**, the **answer on the back**.
4. Students test in pairs, or use them as a starter, plenary or revision carousel. A quick self-test list is on the last content page.

Spec links

GCSE: AQA 8132 §3.4.3 Motivating employees; Edexcel 1BS0 §2.5.4 Motivation; Cambridge IGCSE 0450 §2.1.

A-Level: AQA 7132 §3.6.4 Making human resource decisions: improving motivation and engagement;

Edexcel 9BS0 Theme 1 (1.4.4 Motivation in theory and practice).

AQA GCSE note: 8132 §3.4.3 says specific motivational theories will not be examined. The theory cards suit Edexcel, Cambridge and A-Level.

Teacher tip

Ask students to sort the 24 cards into three piles – financial, non-financial and theory – before they test each other. It forces them to justify each method and surfaces the classic mix – s (enrichment vs enlargement; hy e vs motivator).

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Flashcards – cut out, fold on the dashed line · GCSE & A-Level Business

CONCEPT	CONCEPT
What is motivation?	Why does motivation matter to a business?
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
The desire and drive to put in effort at work. Motivated staff work harder, stay longer and produce better quality.	Higher productivity, better quality and customer service, lower labour turnover and lower absenteeism.

THEORY · TAYLOR	THEORY · MAYO
Taylor – Scientific Management: what motivates workers	Mayo – Human Relations: what did the Hawthorne studies show?
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
Mainly money. Break jobs into simple tasks and pay piece-rate (per unit). Lifts output but ignores social needs.	Workers are motivated by social needs – teamwork, communication and attention from managers – not pay alone.

THEORY · MASLOW	THEORY · HERZBERG
Maslow – Hierarchy of Needs: name the five levels in order.	Herzberg – Two-Factor Theory: hygiene vs motivators?
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
Physiological, safety, social, esteem, self-actualisation. Lower needs must be met before higher ones motivate.	Hygiene factors (pay, conditions) only prevent dissatisfaction. Motivators (achievement, recognition, responsibility) drive real satisfaction.

FINANCIAL	FINANCIAL
Remuneration	Piece rate
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
The total financial reward an employee gets for their work (wages, salary plus any extras).	Pay based on the number of units produced. Rewards speed/output; can hit quality. Links to Taylor.

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FINANCIAL	FINANCIAL
Time rate (wage)	Salary
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
Pay for each hour worked. Simple and fair for hard-to-measure jobs; doesn't reward extra effort.	A fixed annual amount, usually paid monthly. Common for office and professional roles.

FINANCIAL	FINANCIAL
Commission	Bonus
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
A percentage of the sales a worker makes, paid on top of or instead of basic pay. Common in car sales and estate agency.	An extra payment for reaching a target or for strong performance – individual, team or whole-company.

FINANCIAL	FINANCIAL
Profit sharing	Fringe benefits (perks)
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
Employees receive a share of the company's profits. Example: the John Lewis Partnership pays Partners an annual bonus.	Non-cash rewards such as staff discount, a pension, healthcare or a company car.

FINANCIAL	NON-FINANCIAL
Performance-related pay (PRP)	Job enrichment
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
Extra pay linked to how well an individual performs, often judged through appraisal.	Giving an employee more challenging, meaningful tasks and responsibility (vertical loading). Links to Herzberg.

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NON-FINANCIAL	NON-FINANCIAL
Job enlargement	Job rotation
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
Adding more tasks of a similar level to reduce repetition (horizontal loading).	Moving staff between different tasks to reduce boredom – e.g. switching between tills, shelves and deliveries.

NON-FINANCIAL	NON-FINANCIAL
Empowerment	Delegation
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
Giving employees the authority and confidence to make their own decisions about their work.	Passing authority for a task down to a subordinate, while the manager keeps overall responsibility.

NON-FINANCIAL	NON-FINANCIAL
Autonomy	Teamworking
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
The degree of freedom and control a worker has over how they do their own job.	Organising staff into teams so they meet social needs and share ideas. Links to Mayo.

MEASURE	MEASURE
Labour turnover	Absenteeism
----- fold -----	----- fold -----
The percentage of staff who leave each year. A high figure can be a sign of poor motivation.	The percentage of staff absent from work. Rising absence can signal low motivation or morale.

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Quick self-test list · GCSE & A-Level Business

Cover the right-hand column and recall each definition. Then check.

Term	Quick definition
Motivation	Desire and drive to put in effort at work.
Taylor	Money motivates; simplify tasks, pay piece-rate.
Mayo	Social needs motivate – teamwork and communication.
Maslow	Five needs: physiological, safety, social, esteem, self-actualisation.
Herzberg	Hygiene factors stop dissatisfaction; motivators create satisfaction.
Remuneration	Total financial reward for work.
Piece rate	Pay per unit produced.
Time rate	Pay per hour worked.
Salary	Fixed annual pay, usually monthly.
Commission	A percentage of sales made.
Bonus	Extra pay for hitting a target.
Profit sharing	Staff get a share of company profits.
Fringe benefits	Non-cash perks: discount, pension, healthcare.
PRP	Pay linked to individual performance.
Job enrichment	More challenging, meaningful tasks (vertical).
Job enlargement	More tasks of a similar level (horizontal).
Job rotation	Switching staff between tasks to cut boredom.
Empowerment	Giving staff authority to decide.
Delegation	Passing task authority to a subordinate.
Autonomy	Freedom and control over one's own work.
Teamworking	Organising staff into teams to meet social needs.
Labour turnover	% of staff leaving each year.
Absenteeism	% of staff absent from work.

NOTES

Want your students to actually run a business?

These flashcards are free to print and use. They come from **The Business School** – a browser-based classroom simulation where students run a company in real time: they set prices, hire staff, take out loans, file VAT, negotiate deals and react to events, while you watch a live dashboard and the work is auto-graded.

How it works

- 60-minute session, up to 5 teams, up to 30 students
- No installation – students join with a PIN in any browser
- Live teacher dashboard + automatic grading and certificates
- Decisions map to the curriculum (pricing, finance, marketing, people)

Our current pilot cohort is full – join the waitlist for the next round at **thebusiness.school** and we'll send you an invite. More free resources are on the site too.

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